JAMES MATTHEW RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Principal Engineer with 7 years in cloud infrastructure and distributed systems design. I've led the architecture and delivery of large-scale microservices platforms supporting millions of daily transactions, mentored engineering teams through complex migrations, and established patterns that reduced deployment times by 70 percent. I'm particularly interested in solving problems at the intersection of reliability, performance, and developer experience, and I believe that good infrastructure is invisible to the teams using it.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Languages: Go, Python, Java, Bash

Container and Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Message Queues: Kafka, RabbitMQ, SQS

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, Load Balancing, VPN

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jmrichardson/terraform-k8s-bootstrap

github.com/jmrichardson/distributed-cache-patterns

github.com/jmrichardson/microservices-observability-toolkit

github.com/jmrichardson/golang-event-sourcing

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

Artemis Technologies

Oxford, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

artemistech.io

Architected and implemented a multi-region Kubernetes platform handling 500 million requests daily, reducing latency by 35 percent and improving system reliability to 99.99 percent uptime across three geographic regions. Established infrastructure standards and best practices documentation that accelerated onboarding of four new engineering teams and reduced deployment errors by 60 percent. Led migration of legacy monolithic applications to microservices architecture, working with stakeholders across five departments to coordinate cutover and minimize operational risk. Mentored three senior engineers and conducted technical interviews that helped build a

team of 12 infrastructure specialists focused on platform reliability.

Senior Systems Engineer

Nexus Digital Solutions

London, United Kingdom

June 2020 - February 2022

nexusdigital.co

Designed and delivered a containerized CI/CD platform using Jenkins and Kubernetes that reduced build times from 45 minutes to 8 minutes, directly improving developer productivity across 40-person engineering organization. Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana that decreased mean time to detection of production issues from 30 minutes to 3 minutes. Managed AWS infrastructure costs by implementing automated scaling policies and resource optimization, reducing monthly cloud spend by 42 percent while maintaining performance standards. Conducted regular disaster recovery drills and built automated failover systems that proved critical during two unplanned outages, reducing impact duration by 75 percent.

Infrastructure Engineer

Pivot Solutions Ltd

Bristol, United Kingdom

July 2017 - May 2020

pivotsolutions.net

Built and maintained on-premise and cloud infrastructure supporting five product lines serving 200,000 active users, managing systems with 99.5 percent uptime across development, staging, and production environments. Developed Infrastructure as Code templates using Terraform that standardized server provisioning across environments and reduced setup time from 3 days to 30 minutes per new deployment. Implemented log aggregation and centralized monitoring using ELK stack, enabling rapid troubleshooting and reducing average incident resolution time from 2 hours to 20 minutes. Collaborated with application teams to optimize database performance and query efficiency, identifying and resolving bottlenecks that improved API response times by 40 percent.

EDUCATION

University of Oxford

Master of Science in Computer Science

Oxford, United Kingdom

Graduated: September 2017

Dissertation: Distributed Systems Performance Optimization in Containerized Environments

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional

Certified Kubernetes Administrator

HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate